

# Anti-Bullying Policy

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & PREVENTION STRATEGIES

## 1 PURPOSE

To ensure a safe, respectful and nurturing environment where all children and young people are protected from bullying in accordance with Tusla requirements, HIQA National Standards for Children's Residential Centres, Children First 2017 and best practice in children's residential care.

## 2 SCOPE

- ✓ All children and young people placed with Chosanta and all staff, volunteers and visitors
- ✓ All forms of bullying including physical, verbal, social, cyber and discriminatory
- ✓ All locations including the home, school, outings, online and transport
- ✓ Prevention, identification, response and support procedures

## 3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Ensure adequate resources, training and monitoring systems
- ✓ **Care Staff & Key Workers:** Observe interactions, support residents, record incidents and report concerns immediately
- ✓ **Management Team:** Investigate reports, implement sanctions and support plans
- ✓ **All Staff:** Model respectful behaviour, promote anti-bullying culture and complete relevant training
- ✓ **Children and Young People:** Encouraged to speak up and support each other

## 4 PREVENTION STRATEGIES

- ✓ Anti-bullying education included in induction and ongoing programmes
- ✓ Clear, age-appropriate rules co-created with young people and displayed prominently
- ✓ Positive behaviour and inclusion promoted through activities and rewards
- ✓ Risk assessments completed for children identified as vulnerable to bullying
- ✓ Regular discussions in house meetings and key worker sessions

# Anti-Bullying Policy

SECTIONS 5-7: REPORTING & RESPONSE, CHILD INVOLVEMENT & SUPPORT MEASURES

## 5 REPORTING & RESPONSE

- ✓ All incidents of bullying reported and recorded on the same day
- ✓ Immediate safety and support provided to the child experiencing bullying
- ✓ Fair and proportionate response including investigation, mediation and sanctions where appropriate
- ✓ Parents/carers and relevant professionals informed promptly
- ✓ Repeated or serious incidents escalated to management and Tusla if required

## 6 CHILD INVOLVEMENT

- ✓ Children and young people actively involved in developing and reviewing the anti-bullying policy
- ✓ Views of all parties listened to and recorded
- ✓ Peer support and buddy systems encouraged
- ✓ Feedback mechanisms (suggestion boxes, forums, key worker meetings) promoted
- ✓ Concerns raised through any channel are taken seriously and acted upon

## 7 SUPPORT MEASURES

- ✓ Individual support plans developed for both the child experiencing bullying and the child displaying bullying behaviour
- ✓ Counselling, restorative practices and external agency support accessed when needed
- ✓ Ongoing monitoring and check-ins for all involved
- ✓ Staff trained in recognising and responding to different forms of bullying
- ✓ Impact on the child's wellbeing assessed and addressed in care plans



# Anti-Bullying Policy

SECTIONS 8-10: RECORDING & COMPLIANCE, MONITORING & REVIEW

## 8 RECORDING & COMPLIANCE

- ✓ All incidents documented in the incident reporting system and care records
- ✓ Adhering to GDPR and confidentiality while ensuring information is shared appropriately
- ✓ Staff complete anti-bullying training as part of induction and annual refreshers
- ✓ Regular checks of house rules and policy awareness
- ✓ Immediate action taken on any systemic or repeated concerns

## 9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Regular audits of bullying incident records and response times
- ✓ Feedback from children, families and staff on the effectiveness of the policy
- ✓ Analysis of trends and patterns in reported incidents
- ✓ Compliance with individual support plans reviewed monthly
- ✓ Ongoing staff competency checks and refresher training

## 10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually by management or sooner if required
- ✓ Incorporates audit findings, child and family feedback, and regulatory updates
- ✓ Considers trends in bullying incidents and near misses
- ✓ Reviewed policy approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff with sign-off
- ✓ Superseded versions archived per record management procedures